

A.R.I.A.

USER MANUAL

Everything you need to install A.R.I.A. on a USB drive, set her up and use her: agents, local models, voice, the workspace, terminal, Blueprint, computer control, settings and safety.

VERSION 0.34 USB DRIVE · WINDOWS · MACOS · LINUX ENGLISH

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START HERE

01 Welcome to A.R.I.A.

A.R.I.A. is a desktop assistant built around a living core. You talk to her, by typing or by voice, and she hands the work to one of several AI agents. The agents answer questions, build websites and apps, work with your files, run commands, control programs and plan whole projects. She runs from a USB drive on any Windows, macOS or Linux computer, or straight from a folder on your own computer.

1.1 What A.R.I.A. can do

- **Many agents, one interface.** Claude, Gemini, OpenAI models, Mistral, DeepSeek, Groq, OpenRouter and more, or models that run inside A.R.I.A. herself. Each agent has its own job and A.R.I.A. picks the right one for every message, or you choose.
- **Local AI without extra programs.** Download a model from inside A.R.I.A. and run it on your own computer, free and private, with no Ollama or LM Studio needed.
- **Voice, offline.** Natural offline voices in about 40 languages and offline speech recognition. Say her name, or your own wake-up phrase, to start talking.
- **Real work on your computer.** With your permission, agents read and write files, run commands, open programs and websites, print, switch Wi-Fi and Bluetooth, and can click and type in programs that are already open.
- **A workspace you can watch.** Every file, command and action appears in the workspace window: Code, Blueprint, Preview, Files, a real Terminal, Activity and Sessions. Move it to any monitor.
- **Blueprint.** Draw the map of an app yourself or let an agent plan it, then build it part by part.
- **Your rules.** Every kind of action is set to Always, Ask or Never. Agents only reach the folders you allow, and blocked programs are off-limits.

1.2 How this manual is written

- Buttons, tabs and settings look like `Settings › Voice`. The `›` sign means “then open”.
- Keys look like `Ctrl` + `Space`. On a Mac, use `Cmd` wherever this manual says `Ctrl` for copy, cut, paste and select all.
- File and folder names look like `ARIA-data`. `~` means your home folder.
- The interface of A.R.I.A. is in English. She answers in the language you write or speak to her in.

1.3 The words used in this manual

WORD	MEANING
Agent	One AI model with a name, a job and its own settings, for example “Claude — builds websites, apps and code”.
Provider	Where a model runs: Anthropic, Google, OpenAI, a local model inside A.R.I.A., Ollama, and so on.
API key	A password-like code from a provider that lets A.R.I.A. use its models. You create it on the provider's website.

WORD	MEANING
Route	A rule that sends a kind of request (for example “build a website”) to a chosen agent.
Computer tools	The actions an agent may take on your computer: files, commands, programs, devices, system controls.
Core	The animated centre of the screen. It shows what A.R.I.A. is doing and pulses with her voice. Minimised windows wait on its ring.
Workspace	The window with the Code, Blueprint, Preview, Files, Terminal, Activity and Sessions tabs.
Wake word	The name you say to start talking to her without pressing a button.
Portable mode	A.R.I.A. running from a USB drive, keeping everything in the drive's `ARIA-data` folder.

SETUP

02 Installing A.R.I.A. on a USB drive

The USB version is the easiest way to use A.R.I.A.: nothing is installed on the computer, and your settings, keys, voices, models and projects travel with you on the drive. When you unplug it, nothing stays behind.

2.1 What you need

ITEM	DETAILS
USB drive	A fast USB 3 drive, 32 GB or larger. A.R.I.A. takes about 0.5–1 GB per system; offline voices, speech models and local AI models need more (a small local model is 2–5 GB).
The packages	`ARIA-USB-Windows.zip`, `ARIA-USB-macOS.zip` (Apple Silicon and Intel) and `ARIA-USB-Linux.zip`. Take the ones for the systems you use, or all three.
Computers	Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit), macOS 12 (Monterey) or later, or a 64-bit Linux desktop. 8 GB of memory is comfortable; local AI models like 16 GB.
Internet	For cloud agents and for downloading voices and models. Offline voices, speech recognition and local models work without it.
AI access	An API key from at least one cloud provider (Chapter 6), or a local model (Chapter 7).

2.2 Preparing the drive

1. Plug the drive in. Copy anything you want to keep from it to another place: formatting erases the drive.
2. Format it as **exFAT**, so Windows, macOS and Linux can all read and write it.
   Windows: File Explorer › right-click the drive › `Format…` › File system `exFAT` › `Start`.
   macOS: Disk Utility › select the drive › `Erase` › Format `ExFAT`, Scheme `GUID Partition Map`.
   Linux: the Disks app › select the drive › `Format Partition` › `Other` › `exFAT`.
3. Give the drive a short name, for example `ARIA`.

2.3 Copying A.R.I.A. to the drive

1. Unpack each package **directly into the top folder of the drive**, not into a folder of its own. When you open the drive you must see the `ARIA-data` folder right away.
2. If you put several packages on one drive, allow the files to merge. All systems share the same `ARIA-data`, so your settings and keys work everywhere.
3. Unpack the macOS package on a Mac (double-click it in Finder). Unpacking it on Windows can lose the permissions the Mac apps need.

When all three are on the drive, it looks like this:

ON THE DRIVE	WHAT IT IS
`ARIA-data`	Her memory: settings, sessions, skills, voices, speech and AI models, and your password-protected API keys. Never rename or delete it.
`ARIA Workspace`	Projects the agents build. Created at the first start.
`Start ARIA (Windows).bat`	Starts her on Windows.
`Start ARIA (Mac).command`	Starts her on a Mac (picks Apple Silicon or Intel by itself).
`Start ARIA (Linux).sh`	Starts her on Linux.
`Windows`, `macOS`, `Linux`	The app for each system, each with an `Auto-start` folder (2.8).
`README.txt`	A short version of this chapter.

2.4 First start on Windows

1. Open the drive in File Explorer and double-click `Start ARIA (Windows).bat`.
2. Windows may show `Windows protected your PC`, because the app is not signed by a company. Click `More info` › `Run anyway`. It asks only the first time on each computer.
3. The password window appears (2.7), then the main screen.

2.5 First start on macOS

1. Open the drive in Finder. **Right-click** `Start ARIA (Mac).command` › `Open` › `Open`. A plain double-click is blocked the first time.
2. If macOS still says the app cannot be opened, open Terminal and type `xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine /Volumes/ARIA/macOS` (use your drive's name), then try again.
3. When asked, allow access to removable volumes, the microphone and, for program control, Accessibility and Screen Recording (System Settings › Privacy & Security).

2.6 First start on Linux

1. Open the drive in your file manager and run `Start ARIA (Linux).sh` (right-click › `Run as a Program`, or in a terminal: `bash "Start ARIA (Linux).sh"`).
2. If nothing happens, install FUSE 2 once: `sudo apt install libfuse2` (Ubuntu, Debian, Mint), then start again.

2.7 Your password

On a USB drive, API keys are protected by a password of your choice instead of the computer's keychain, so they work on every computer and are useless to anyone who finds the drive.

- At the first start, choose a password and type it twice. At every later start, A.R.I.A. asks for it before she opens.
- The password cannot be recovered. If you forget it, choose `Forgot password?`: a new, empty key store is created and you paste your API keys again. Everything else stays.

2.8 Starting by herself when the drive is plugged in

No system lets a USB drive start a program on its own any more (that is how viruses used to spread). On your own computers you can install a small helper once. It needs no administrator rights, works only for your user account and uses almost no processor time. From then on A.R.I.A. starts a few seconds after you plug the drive in.

SYSTEM	INSTALL (ONCE PER COMPUTER)	REMOVE
Windows	Open `Windows › Auto-start` and double-click `Install auto-start.bat`. If Windows warns you, click `More info` › `Run anyway`. A window says `Done`; press any key.	`Remove auto-start.bat`
macOS	Open `macOS › Auto-start`, right-click `Install auto-start.command` › `Open` › `Open`. The first time you plug the drive in, allow access to removable volumes.	`Remove auto-start.command`
Linux	Open `Linux › Auto-start` in a terminal and run `bash install-autostart.sh`. It works at once and after every login.	`bash remove-autostart.sh`

To test it, unplug the drive, wait a moment and plug it in again. If she is already running, the helper does not open her a second time. After updating A.R.I.A. (2.9) the helper keeps working; there is no need to install it again.

> **IF SHE DOES NOT START BY HERSELF**
>
> The helper looks for `ARIA-data` in the top folder of the drive together with the app for this system. If you unpacked into a sub-folder (for example `ARIA-USB-Windows/ARIA-data`), move its contents up to the top folder.

2.9 Updating to a new version

1. Close A.R.I.A.
2. Unpack the new packages into the top folder of the drive and allow the files to be replaced.
3. Start her as usual. `ARIA-data` is never replaced, so all settings, keys, voices, models and sessions stay. Folders from older versions are renamed for you.

2.10 Unplugging safely

Close A.R.I.A. first, then use `Safely Remove Hardware` (Windows), `Eject` (macOS) or `Unmount` (Linux). Pulling the drive out while she is writing settings or downloading a model can damage those files.

2.11 Using A.R.I.A. from the computer's disk

The same packages also run from a folder on the computer, with nothing to install. A desktop shortcut to the app makes starting quicker.

- **Copy the whole drive** (or unpack a package) into a folder on the disk, for example `C:\Apps\ARIA` or `~/Applications/ARIA`, and start her with the same start file. With `ARIA-data` next to it, she works exactly as on the drive, with your password and everything in that folder.
- **Without `ARIA-data`** (delete it from the copy), she keeps her settings in your user account instead (Chapter 25) and protects your keys with the system keychain, so no password is asked.

SETUP

03 The five-minute setup

1. **Your language.** At the very first start, a small window asks for your native language. A.R.I.A. downloads a free offline voice for it and one for English, so she can answer aloud in both. You can change this later in `Settings › Voice`.
2. **Connect an agent.** Open `Settings` (the gear, top right) › `Agents`, click an agent, press `Get an API key ↗`, create a key on the provider's page and paste it into `API key`. Press `Load models`, choose a model and press `Test connection`. No key? Download a local model instead (Chapter 7).
3. **Speech recognition.** In `Settings › Listening › Speech recognition`, download a model (Parakeet v3 for most European languages) and press `Use`. Try `Test: record 4 seconds`.
4. **Permissions.** Look through `Settings › Permissions`: what agents may do without asking, and which folders they may use (Chapter 22).

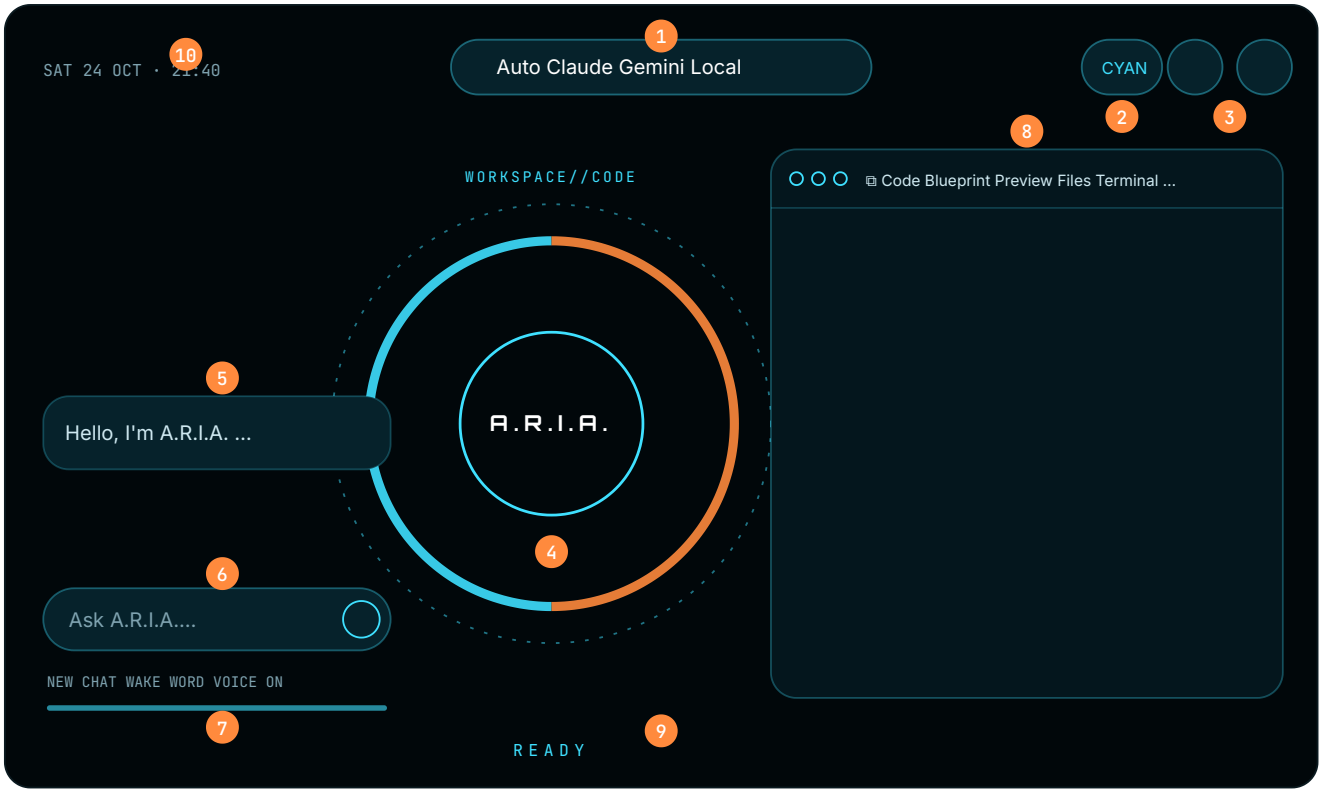
SAVING

Settings are saved automatically a moment after each change. There is no Save button. Each settings page is made of groups that fold to one line showing their current state; `EXPAND ALL` and `COLLAPSE ALL` sit at the top of each page.

SETTINGS GROUP	PAGES
Assistant	Agents · Routing · Skills · Plugins · MCP servers · Local models
Voice	Voice (how she sounds) · Listening (speech recognition, wake word)
Computer	Devices · Windows & files · Permissions · Open programs
Look	Appearance · Support me

ORIENTATION

04 A tour of the screen



1 Agent buttons: Auto or a fixed agent
2 Theme switch (cycles the 12 themes)
3 Full screen and Settings (gear)
4 The core, its ring and her name
5 Chat messages
6 Message box, microphone, Send / Stop
7 New chat, Wake word, Voice on/off, progress
8 Workspace window with its tabs
9 Status: Ready, Thinking, Speaking, Listening...
10 Date, time and live system readouts

The main screen, simplified. The numbered parts are explained below.

4.1 Top bar

- **Agent buttons (1).** `Auto` lets A.R.I.A. choose the agent for every message. Press an agent's name to send everything to that agent. The line underneath shows the chosen agent's job.
- **Theme (2)** switches to the next of the 12 colour themes.
- **Full screen (3)**, or `F11`. With more than one monitor, the core continues across the other screens (Chapter 21).
- **Settings (3)**, the gear, opens all settings. Close them with the round `×` or `Esc`.

4.2 The core, its ring and the HUD

The core (4) shows her state: it turns faster while an agent works and pulses with her voice while she speaks. Small readouts (10) show the processor load, the active agent and route, tasks, memory and battery. Under the core, the status (9) reads `READY`, `THINKING`, `SPEAKING`, `LISTENING`, `TRANSCRIBING` or `WAITING FOR YOU`.

Names on the **ring around the core** are things waiting for you: the minimised chat (`CHAT//READY`, `CHAT//2 NEW`), the minimised workspace (`WORKSPACE//CODE`), programs A.R.I.A. opened, and a device you just plugged in. Click a name to bring it back. Names never overlap; when there is no room, they are gathered under `+N MORE`.

4.3 Chat and the controls under it

- **Messages (5)** are shown in your theme's colours. Each reply is labelled with the agent that wrote it.
- **Message box (6)**: type and press `Enter`; `Shift` + `Enter` adds a line. The microphone button records your voice. The arrow sends; while an agent works it becomes `Stop`. While she speaks, a `STOP` button appears to silence her.
- **Under the box (7)**: `NEW CHAT`, `WAKE WORD` (on/off), `VOICE ON / OFF`, then the progress bar, the `HEARD` line and an orange badge while she controls programs.
- The small circle in the chat tools **minimises the chat into the core**. It flies onto the ring as `CHAT//READY`; new replies show as `CHAT//1 NEW`. Click the name to bring it back.

4.4 The workspace window

The workspace (8) floats over the core and opens by itself when an agent writes a file or shows something. Its three dots minimise it into the core, maximise it and reset its place; the ⧉ button moves it into its own window on any monitor. Chapter 12 explains it in full.

EVERYDAY USE

05 Chatting with A.R.I.A.

5.1 Sending a message

1. Type your request in the message box, in any language, and press `Enter`.
2. The status changes to `THINKING` and the progress bar appears under the chat.
3. The reply appears in the chat. With `VOICE ON`, she also reads it aloud.

She remembers the conversation, so you can follow up with “make the heading bigger” or “and in English?”. `NEW CHAT` starts over; the old conversation is kept in Sessions (5.9).

5.2 Choosing who answers

With `Auto`, A.R.I.A. picks the agent from the routing table (Chapter 8). Requests to plan or map an app go to an agent with computer tools, preferably Claude. To force an agent, press its name in the top bar.

5.3 Following the work

While an agent works, a slim bar under the chat shows what it is doing now (for example `Building · todo-app/index.html`), finished actions with a ✓, and on the right the step, the number of files written and the time: `STEP 3 · 2 FILES · 0:41`. It turns orange when waiting for your approval or when the task stopped. The Activity tab keeps the full list.

5.4 Approving actions

When an action is set to Ask (Chapter 22), the agent pauses and the chat shows the exact action, for example “Write file .../ARIA Workspace/site/index.html”.

- `Allow` runs this one action. `Deny` refuses it; the agent asks what you would like instead.
- `Allow for this task` (for actions in open programs) approves every action of that kind until the task ends.

5.5 Stopping

- **Stop the task:** press `Stop` (the send button while she works).
- **Stop her voice:** press the `STOP` button next to the message box, press `Esc`, or simply say “stop” (also “enough”, “quiet”, or the same word in your language). Saying stop needs an offline speech model.
- **Stop program control:** `Esc` anywhere, or push the mouse into the top-left corner of any screen (Chapter 19).

5.6 When an agent stops in the middle of a task

Big jobs (a whole website, a long file, many files in one go) can be larger than what an AI model may write in one reply. A.R.I.A. notices this and asks the agent to continue in smaller pieces by itself. If the agent still stops before the job is done (it says its reply kept getting cut off, the task ends early, or files are missing), type:

TYPE THIS

`continue in smaller steps`

The agent picks up where it stopped and writes the rest one file or one part at a time. You can be specific: “continue in smaller steps — finish styles.css, then app.js”.

To avoid it from the start, ask for big things in stages: “first the home page”, then “now the gallery page”. For an app, plan it in Blueprint (Chapter 16) and build part by part.

5.7 Good requests

INSTEAD OF	TRY
“Make a website.”	“Build a one-page website for my bakery: menu, opening hours, map link, warm colours.”
“Clean my computer.”	“List the files in Downloads older than 30 days and move the installers to the trash.”
“Open music.”	“Play the MP3s in Music/Jazz in the player.”
“Plan an app.”	“Plan a booking app for a hair salon: clients pick a stylist and a time and get an SMS reminder.”
“Make it look nice.”	“Build a notes app in ARIA style.” (Chapter 17)

5.8 Slash commands

Type `/` in the message box to see commands that come with plugins (Chapter 9), for example `/check-site`. Pick one with the arrow keys and `Enter`, or keep typing its name.

5.9 Sessions

Every conversation is saved. The `Sessions` tab of the workspace lists them with date and size; search them, rename or delete them, or open one to bring back the chat, what the agents remembered, the files in Code and what Preview showed.

06 Agents and AI providers

An agent is one AI model with a name and a job. A.R.I.A. starts with three; add as many as you like with `+ Add agent`. Click an agent's line to open its settings.

6.1 The default agents

AGENT	PROVIDER AND MODEL	JOB	COMPUTER TOOLS
Claude	Anthropic, claude-sonnet-5-5	Builds websites, apps and code	On
Gemini	Google Gemini, gemini-3.8-flash	Conversation, questions and knowledge	Off
Local	Ollama, qwen2.5:7b	Files, folders and computer control (offline)	On

Model names change often. If a model is not found, press `Load models` and choose from the list your key offers.

6.2 The fields of an agent

FIELD	WHAT IT DOES
On / off	A switched-off agent is not used and leaves the top bar.
Name, responsibility	Shown on its button and under the top bar; the agent is told its job.
Provider	Where the model runs (6.3). Choosing one fills in the right server address.
API key	Your key from the provider, stored encrypted. Not needed for local models.
Model	Press `Load models` to choose. For the Built-in provider, pick one of your downloaded models.
Server address	Leave empty for the default. Fill in for a custom or remote server.
Creativity	Low for exact work (files, code), higher for writing and ideas. Models that refuse it are handled automatically.
Computer tools	Lets the agent use files, the terminal, programs, devices and the other tools in Chapter 18. Without it, it only answers.
Test connection	Sends a tiny request and shows whether the key, model and address work.

6.3 Providers

PROVIDER	NOTES
Anthropic (Claude)	Key from the Claude Console. Best for building with computer tools.
Google Gemini	Key from Google AI Studio; free tier with limits.
OpenAI	Key from the OpenAI platform; billed separately from ChatGPT.
Mistral · DeepSeek · xAI (Grok)	Cloud models with their own keys.

PROVIDER	NOTES
Groq · Together AI	Open models on fast cloud hardware.
OpenRouter	One key for hundreds of models from many companies.
Perplexity	Answers from the web. Cannot use computer tools.
Built-in	Runs a downloaded model inside A.R.I.A. (Chapter 7). Free, private, offline.
Ollama · LM Studio	Local models served by those programs on your computer.
Cline (coding agent)	Runs the Cline coding agent (install with `npm i -g cline`, sign in once with `cline auth`). Its work appears in Activity, Code and Terminal; A.R.I.A. asks before each Cline task.
Custom server	Any server that speaks the OpenAI chat format.

6.4 When a provider is busy

If a server is overloaded (429, 500–504, 529), A.R.I.A. waits and retries up to three times. Messages that still fail explain the cause (Chapter 24). Switching to another agent usually helps.

6.5 When an agent stops halfway

REMEMBER

If an agent stops before finishing a task — because its replies were cut off, it ran out of steps, or it simply ends early — type **continue in smaller steps**. It continues where it stopped, one file or part at a time. See 5.6.

SETTINGS › LOCAL MODELS

07 Local models inside A.R.I.A.

A.R.I.A. can run AI models herself: free, private and offline, with no Ollama or LM Studio. Models come from Hugging Face in the GGUF format and run on your graphics card when it has room, otherwise on the processor.

7.1 Getting a model

1. Open `Settings › Local models`. The top shows `ON THIS COMPUTER`: memory, graphics card and processor.
2. Choose from `Recommended`, `TRENDING NOW · FROM TRUSTED PUBLISHERS`, or `Search models` (try “qwen”, “llama”, “gemma”).
3. Each model shows its sizes (quantisations) and how well each fits this computer: on the graphics card, partly on it, on the processor, tight, or too big. A 4B model (about 2.5 GB) is a good start.
4. Press `Download`. Downloads continue where they stopped if the connection breaks.
5. Press `Use it` to give the model to an agent, or choose it in `Settings › Agents` with the provider `Built-in`.

7.2 Updates and your own files

- `Check for updates` asks Hugging Face whether your models have new versions and shows `Update available` or `Up to date`.
- `Add a .gguf file…` uses a model file you already have. Removing it from the list never deletes your own file.
- A model is loaded when an agent first needs it and unloaded after 10 minutes without use, to free memory.

> **ON A USB DRIVE**
> Models are stored in `ARIA-data`, so they come with you to every computer. A fast USB 3 drive loads them in seconds; a slow one takes longer the first time.

7.3 Ollama and LM Studio

If you already use them, keep them: set an agent's provider to `Ollama` or `LM Studio`, press `Load models` and `Test connection`. Their models live on each computer, not on the USB drive.

08 Routing: who does what

8.1 How a message is routed

1. If you pressed an agent's button, that agent answers.
2. Requests to plan, map or sketch an app go to the planning agent (an agent with computer tools, preferably Claude).
3. Otherwise A.R.I.A. compares the message with each task's keywords. The task with most matches wins. Keywords match the start of words, so “aplikac” also matches “aplikację”.
4. If nothing matches, the default task answers.

8.2 The default tasks

TASK	SOME KEYWORDS	AGENT
Build — websites, apps & code	build, website, app, code, script, html, css, javascript, python, react, bug	Claude
System — files & computer control	file, folder, downloads, delete, move, wifi, bluetooth, volume, open, launch, terminal, battery	Local
Chat — conversation & knowledge	(none — the default)	Gemini

8.3 Changing the routing

Turn `Automatic routing` off to always use the agent picked at the top. Edit a task's name, agent and keywords (comma-separated, in every language you use), add tasks with `New task`, and choose the fallback under `When nothing matches`.

09 Skills, plugins and MCP servers

9.1 Skills

A skill teaches agents how you want a kind of work done: your style, a checklist, a workflow. It is a folder with a `SKILL.md` file, the same format Claude and Cline use. Agents see each skill's name and "when to use" line and read the full text only when a task fits.

- `New skill` writes one from scratch; `Import .md file` and `Import folder` bring existing ones.
- Or say in the chat: "save this as a skill".
- Each skill can be switched on or off and limited to chosen agents.

9.2 Plugins and slash commands

A plugin bundles skills, slash commands and MCP servers. Install with `Install .zip`, `Install folder` or `Install from GitHub`, and choose which agents may use it. The built-in **web-toolkit** plugin brings the *website-check* skill, the `/check-site` command and a site-checking server.

9.3 MCP servers

MCP servers give agents extra tools: memory, documentation, databases, services. Ready-made servers can be added with one click:

SERVER	WHAT IT ADDS
Memory	A notebook agents keep between conversations. Built in; stored in A.R.I.A.'s data.
Context7	Up-to-date documentation for programming libraries.
DeepWiki	Answers about public GitHub repositories.
Sequential thinking	Helps agents reason step by step (needs Node.js).

Each server has a permission (Always, Ask, Never) and a list of agents that may use it. Its actions appear in Activity like A.R.I.A.'s own tools.

10 Her voice

10.1 Speaking

- `Read replies aloud` (also `VOICE ON / OFF` under the chat) turns her voice on or off.
- `Say “stop” to interrupt her`: while she talks, the microphone listens only for stop words. The STOP button and `Esc` always work.

10.2 Modulators

MODULATOR	SOUND
Aria	Natural and warm
Nova	Deep and calm
Echo	Robotic, synthetic
Titan	AI core with reverb

Click one to hear it. Fine-tune with `Speed, pitch & volume` and `Play sample`.

10.3 Voice engines

ENGINE	DESCRIPTION
System	The voices built into your system. Works at once; modulators change only speed and pitch.
Offline · Piper + Kokoro	Natural voices that run on your computer: Piper voices for about 40 languages and Kokoro with 11 natural English voices. Free, unlimited, full modulator effects.
Cloud	An OpenAI-compatible speech service: address, key, model and voice. Paid per use.

10.4 Native language and offline voices

1. Choose `Your native language`.
2. Download a voice from the list under that language and one under English. `Other languages` lists the rest.
3. Choose `Voice for … replies (native)` and `Voice for English & other replies`; press `Preview` to hear each.

She uses the native voice when she answers in your language and the English voice for everything else. The speakers she uses are chosen in `Settings › Devices`.

SETTINGS › LISTENING

11 Talking to A.R.I.A.

11.1 Push to talk

- Hold the microphone button, speak, let go. Or click it once to start and once to stop.
- Hold `Ctrl` + `Space` anywhere in the window.

11.2 Speech recognition models

Recognition runs on your computer. Download a model, press `Use`, and set `Language you speak` (or Automatic).

MODEL	LANGUAGES	SIZE
Parakeet v3 (NVIDIA) — recommended	25 European languages, fast, does not make up text	465 MB
Whisper Tiny / Base / Small	About 90 languages	111 / 198 / 610 MB
Canary 180M Flash	English, German, Spanish, French	147 MB
Parakeet v2 · Parakeet 110M	English (most accurate · small and fast)	460 / 100 MB
Moonshine Tiny / Base	English, quickest for voice commands	103 / 239 MB
Whisper Base (English)	English	199 MB

`Test: record 4 seconds` shows what she understood. Choose the microphone in `Settings › Devices`.

11.3 The wake word

Turn on `Wake word` (or press `WAKE WORD` under the chat) and she listens for her name, offline. Say “Aria, what's the weather tomorrow?”, put the name at the end (“open my downloads, Aria”), or say “Aria”, wait for the chime and then speak.

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Names she answers to	Spellings the speech model may write (aria, arya, arja…). Add any spelling you see in the `HEARD` line.
Conversation mode	After she answers, reply without saying her name.
Advanced	How long she waits for the command, microphone sensitivity, the chime, and answering without her name (best in a quiet room).

11.4 The wake-up greeting

In `Settings › Appearance › Wake-up greeting`, type a phrase (for example “good morning”) and her answer (“Good morning, sir. What are we doing today?”). Say the phrase and she greets you; with `Then listen for my answer` on, just say what you want next. Several phrases or greetings, one per line, are allowed — she picks a greeting at random. It uses the offline speech model.

WORKSPACE

12 The workspace window

The workspace shows everything the agents produce and do.

TAB	WHAT YOU FIND THERE
Code	Files the agents write, live as they are written, with syntax colours. `Clear` empties the view; files on disk stay.
Blueprint	The map of an app, drawn by you or an agent (Chapter 16).
Preview	Websites, pages being built, pictures, videos, PDFs, the music player and open apps (Chapter 14).
Files	A file manager for your computer (Chapter 13).
Terminal	A real terminal, plus the commands agents ran (Chapter 15).
Activity	A timeline of every action, approval, denial and error.
Sessions	All saved conversations (5.9).

12.1 Moving and resizing

- Drag the top bar to move it; drag an edge or corner to resize; double-click the bar to maximise or restore.
- The three dots: **minimise** (it flies into the core and waits on the ring as `WORKSPACE//CODE` — click the name to bring it back), **maximise**, and **reset** its size and place.

12.2 Its own window, on any monitor

Press ⧉ in the workspace bar, or drag the bar past the edge of the main window and let go, to move the whole workspace into its own window. Put it on any monitor, maximise it or snap it like any other window. Everything keeps working: open files, the terminal, Blueprint, the music player. A website shown in Preview reloads once.

- Press ⧉ again, the reset dot, or close that window to put the workspace back. Nothing is lost.
- Its place on the screen is remembered and it opens there again next time.
- In full screen, it stays above the core's extension on the other monitors.

12.3 The footer

The path of the file being shown, with `Open` (its own program or Preview) and `Show in folder`.

13 Files

A file manager inside the workspace: places (Home, Desktop, Documents, Downloads, Pictures, Music, Videos, ARIA Workspace) and drives, back, forward and up, a clickable path, search, list or grid view with picture thumbnails, sorting and hidden files.

ACTION	HOW
Select	Click; `Ctrl`-click or `Shift`-click for several
Open	Double-click: text and code open in Code, pictures, video, music and web pages in Preview
Rename	`F2`
Move to the trash	`Delete`
Copy, cut, paste	`Ctrl` + `C` / `X` / `V`
Move / copy by dragging	Drag onto a folder; hold `Ctrl` to copy
More	Right-click: new folder, properties, open with the system app, `Ask A.R.I.A. about this`
Send to chat	`→ Chat` puts the selected paths into your message

TRASH, NOT ERASE

Deleting, by you or by an agent, moves items to your system's trash or recycle bin, where you can restore them.

14 Preview and the music player

14.1 What Preview shows

CONTENT	HOW IT IS SHOWN
Pages being built	The page runs live, with Desktop, Tablet and Mobile sizes, so you can click through a site right after it is built.
Websites	A built-in browser with Back, Forward, Reload and `Open in browser`.
Pictures, videos, PDF	Fitted to the window; videos with controls; PDFs with pages and zoom.
Music	The music player (14.2).

What opens in Preview and what in its own program is set in `Settings › Windows & files` (Chapter 20). When `Control open programs` is on, websites always open in your external browser, where agents control them, and Preview is kept for pages being built, code and music.

14.2 The music player

Opening an MP3, FLAC, WAV, M4A, OGG, AAC or Opus file starts the player; the other songs in the folder become *Up next*. Cover art and tags, a ring spectrum in your theme colours, play/pause, previous/next, seek, volume, repeat and shuffle. `Space` plays and pauses, `←` / `→` jump 5 seconds. Music gets quieter while you or A.R.I.A. speak, and a small *now playing* button brings the player back from other tabs.

14.3 Open apps

`Open apps` lists the program windows open on your computer. Press a name to bring it to the front or `×` to close it politely (the program can still ask to save).

15 The terminal

The Terminal tab is a real terminal, the same as the one built into your system. Type commands, run programs, use ssh, python, nano or top.

SYSTEM	SHELL
Windows	PowerShell. Also PowerShell 7, Command Prompt, Git Bash and WSL when they are installed.
macOS	Your login shell (zsh), plus bash.
Linux	Your shell (usually bash), plus zsh or fish if installed.

- The shell starts the first time you open the tab, in the `ARIA Workspace` folder.
- `Shell` shows the terminal; `Agents` shows the commands agents ran and what they printed. An orange number counts new agent commands.
- The list next to them switches shells. `New` starts a fresh shell, `Clear` empties the screen.
- When you type `exit`, the shell ends; press `Enter` for a new one.

KEYS	ACTION
`Ctrl` + `C`	Stop the running command
`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `C` (Mac: `Cmd` + `C`)	Copy the selected text
`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `V` (Mac: `Cmd` + `V`; Windows also `Ctrl` + `V`)	Paste. Pasted text waits for `Enter`.

YOUR OWN COMMANDS

Commands you type run with your rights, without asking, like in any terminal. Agents' commands still follow the Terminal permission (Chapter 22).

16 Blueprint: planning an app

A blueprint is the map of an app: its parts, what each does, how they connect and which agent builds each one. Draw it yourself, let an agent plan it, or both.

16.1 Starting a blueprint

- **Plan it with AI:** describe the app (“a booking app for a hair salon with SMS reminders”) and press `Plan it with AI`, or ask in the chat.
- **Draw it yourself:** `Empty map` or a template: `Website`, `Web app with accounts`, `REST API`.
- **Map an existing project folder…** draws a map of a project you already have.

16.2 The toolbox

TOOL	USE
Select & move `V`	Drag parts; drag on empty space to select several.
Move the map `H`	Or hold `Space` and drag.
Data flow `C`	Drag from one part to another to show data moving between them.
Belongs to `P`	Drag a part onto the part it belongs inside.
Parts	App, Area, Module, Screen, Service, Data, File and Note. Click one and then the map, or drag it there. Double-click empty space to add a part.
Undo / Redo	`Ctrl` + `Z` / `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `Z`
Delete, Tidy up, Snap	Delete the selection; arrange everything as a tree again; snap to a grid.
Zoom, Show everything `F`, Mini-map	Find your way around big maps.

Right-click a part for rename, duplicate, colours, align and spacing. Click a part to edit its details on the side: name, description, files, agent and status. `Find part…` searches, `Map` / `Agents` switches between the tree and the parts grouped by agent.

16.3 The bar above the map

BUTTON	WHAT IT DOES
Export ▾	Markdown, a Mermaid diagram, or a picture (SVG or PNG).
AI review	An agent looks for missing parts and adds them, with questions as notes.
New	Starts another blueprint (the current one stays saved).
Clear	Removes every part from the current map. `Ctrl` + `Z` brings them back.
Build all	Builds every unfinished part in order, each with its own agent. `Stop` ends it.

BIG BUILDS

Building part by part is the best way to build big apps. If an agent stops halfway through a part, type **continue in smaller steps** (5.6).

BUILDING

17 Apps in the ARIA style

Apps and websites the agents build can look like A.R.I.A.: your theme colours, glass panels, HUD labels and the neural network background. Ask for it in the chat, for example “build a notes app in ARIA style” or “make a dashboard that looks like Aria”. The request works in any language.

- The agent copies the ARIA UI kit into the project's `aria/` folder (with your current theme and light or dark mode) and starts from one of five layouts: **app** (side panel and content), **dashboard** (number cards and a chart), **tool** (one focused window), **site** (a landing page) or **core**.
- A.R.I.A.'s core (the HUD rings) is used only when you ask for it, for example “...with the core”.
- Existing projects can be restyled. Your files are never overwritten without asking.
- `Settings › Appearance › Apps you build`: always use the style, and `Show an example` opens a sample in Preview.

COMPUTER TOOLS

18 What agents can do on your computer

Agents with `Computer tools` on can use these tools. Each belongs to a permission (Chapter 22).

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES	PERMISSION
List, read, search files	Looks into folders and reads files and documents.	Read files
Write files, folders	Creates and changes files, for example a website's pages.	Create & edit files
Move, rename, delete	Organises files; deleting moves to the trash.	Move & delete
Run command	Runs a command, for example installing a package or a test.	Terminal
Open websites and files	In Preview or their own program.	Browser
Programs, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, volume	Starts programs, switches connections, changes the volume, locks the screen.	System controls
Devices	Lists printers, drives, USB devices and monitors; prints files; safely removes drives.	System controls
See / control programs	Reads windows; clicks and types in them (Chapter 19).	See / Control programs
Blueprint, ARIA style, skills	Draws plans, sets up the ARIA UI kit, reads skills.	Create & edit files

18.1 Limits that always apply

- Agents only reach the allowed folders. Paths outside are refused.
- Blocked programs cannot be opened or controlled; A.R.I.A.'s own windows are never controlled.
- Commands run in your account, without administrator rights.
- A task has a maximum number of steps, so a confused agent cannot loop forever. If it stops, type **continue in smaller steps**.

SETTINGS › OPEN PROGRAMS

19 Controlling open programs

A.R.I.A. can work inside programs that are already open: fill in a form, click a button, type into a document. It is off until you switch it on.

19.1 Turning it on

1. Open `Settings › Open programs › Control open programs` and turn it on.
2. Choose `Window elements` (Windows: reads buttons and fields by name — fast and exact) and/or `Screen, mouse & keyboard` (any system: looks at a screenshot, then clicks and types).
3. Choose `Who looks at the screen`: a model that understands pictures (Claude, Gemini, GPT, or a local vision model).
4. Set `See open programs` and `Control programs` to Always, Ask or Never, and give programs Allow, Ask or Block under `Programs agents may start`.

While it is on, websites open only in your external browser and agents control them there.

19.2 Watching and stopping

- An orange badge under the chat shows while she controls programs.
- Press `Esc` in any program, or push the mouse into the **top-left corner** of any screen, to stop at once.
- Every click, key and text appears in Activity.

> TAKE CARE
> Do not use the mouse and keyboard while she does. Agents are told never to type passwords or confirm payments; still, block programs that hold money, passwords or messages you cannot take back.

19.3 System requirements

SYSTEM	WHAT IS NEEDED
Windows	Nothing extra. Programs running as administrator cannot be controlled.
macOS	Allow A.R.I.A. in Privacy & Security › Accessibility and Screen Recording; mouse clicks need cliclick (`brew install cliclick`).
Linux	An X11 session with xdotool and wmctrl (`sudo apt install xdotool wmctrl`). Wayland does not allow it.

SETTINGS › COMPUTER

20 Devices, windows and files

20.1 Devices

GROUP	WHAT IT DOES
Wi-Fi & Bluetooth	Switches, the connected network, a network scan and paired devices.
Connected devices	Printers (with `Test page`), drives (`Open`, `Safely remove`), USB devices and monitors. Updated by itself when something is plugged in or out.
Camera, microphone & speakers	Camera preview, the microphone she listens with (with a level test) and the speakers she talks through.
System volume	Volume and mute.
Quick actions	Lock screen and shortcuts to your system's settings.

When you plug something in, she tells you in a line under the chat and, for a moment, its name shows on the core's ring; she can say it aloud, and a new drive offers `Open`, `Safely remove` or ignore. Turn these off under `Connected devices › Advanced`. Agents can do the same on request: “print the report on the HP”, “eject the pendrive”.

20.2 Windows & files

- **Open in Preview or a window:** for websites, web pages, pictures, videos, music, PDFs and text, choose Preview or their own window. Office documents always open in their own program.
- **Where programs open:** on another monitor (keeps her screen free), on her monitor, on a chosen display, or not moved. Linux needs wmctrl, macOS the Accessibility permission. On Windows, the taskbar can hide while she is in full screen.
- **This computer:** overview, storage, network and displays.

SETTINGS › LOOK

21 Appearance and Support me

21.1 Appearance

GROUP	WHAT IT DOES
Name	Any name up to 16 characters, or a preset (A.R.I.A., E.V.E., J.A.R.V.I.S., F.R.I.D.A.Y. ...). With `Answer to this name`, it becomes the wake word.
Wake-up greeting	Your phrase and her answer (11.4).
Theme & mode	12 themes — Cyan, Ember, Violet, Mono, Emerald, Crimson, Gold, Arctic, Rose, Ocean, Neon, Matrix — dark, light or auto, window transparency, animations.
Core	HUD, HUD Depth, Pulsar, Globe, Hive or Nebula, and the core size.
Background & monitors	The neural network: on/off, density, intensity, brightness. `Extend to other monitors` continues the core across all screens in full screen.
Apps you build	The ARIA style for apps the agents build (Chapter 17).

21.2 Support me

A.R.I.A. is free. If she helps you and you would like to thank the author, open `Settings › Support me` and buy him a coffee on Ko-fi:

- **With your phone:** scan the QR code with the phone's camera and pay in a few taps with Apple Pay, Google Pay or the phone's wallet.
- **In your browser:** `Buy me a coffee ↗` opens `ko-fi.com/aria_assistant`; pay by card or PayPal, no account needed.

SCAN TO BUY ME A COFFEE

Point your phone's camera at the code. It opens **ko-fi.com/aria_assistant**, where you can pay with Apple Pay, Google Pay, your phone's wallet, a card or PayPal. Thank you!

Payments are handled by Ko-fi with Stripe and PayPal. A.R.I.A. never sees your card details.

22 Permissions, privacy and your keys

22.1 Action permissions

PERMISSION	COVERS	DEFAULT
Read files	Listing, reading and searching files; system information	Always
Create & edit files	Writing files, new folders, blueprints, the ARIA style kit	Ask
Move & delete	Moving, renaming, sending to the trash	Ask
Terminal	Agents running commands	Ask
Browser	Opening websites	Always
System controls	Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, volume, lock screen, opening files, printing, ejecting drives	Ask
See open programs	Listing windows, reading them, screenshots	Always
Control programs	Clicking and typing in open programs	Ask

22.2 Folders

Agents reach only the folders listed under `Folders` and what is inside them: by default ARIA Workspace, Documents, Downloads, Desktop, Music, Pictures and Videos. `+ Add folder` adds one; `×` removes one. The workspace (`Change`) is where new projects go.

22.3 Privacy

- **What leaves your computer:** your messages, and file contents an agent reads, go to the provider of the agent that answers. Local models keep everything on your computer.
- **Voice:** offline speech recognition, the wake word and offline voices never send audio anywhere.
- **Screenshots** for program control go to the agent in `Who looks at the screen`; use a local vision model to keep them local.
- **API keys** are encrypted: with your password on a USB drive (2.7), or with the system keychain on a computer. They are never shown in full again.
- **No tracking:** A.R.I.A. sends no usage statistics.

REFERENCE

23 Keyboard shortcuts

CHAT AND VOICE

`Enter`	Send
`Shift` + `Enter`	New line
`/`	Slash commands
`Ctrl` + `Space` (hold)	Talk
`Esc`	Stop her voice; stop program control; close Settings
`F11`	Full screen

TERMINAL

`Ctrl` + `C`	Stop the command
`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `C`	Copy
`Ctrl` + `Shift` + `V`	Paste

BLUEPRINT

`V` · `H` · `C` · `P`	Select · Move map · Data flow · Belongs to
`Ctrl` + `Z` / + `Shift`	Undo / Redo
`Ctrl` + `D`	Duplicate
`Delete` · `F`	Delete · Show everything

FILES AND MUSIC

`F2` · `Delete`	Rename · Trash
`Ctrl` + `C` / `X` / `V`	Copy / cut / paste
`Space` · `←` `→`	Play/pause · ±5 seconds

On a Mac, use `Cmd` instead of `Ctrl` for copy, cut, paste, undo and select all.

HELP

24 Troubleshooting

24.1 Agents

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
The agent stopped before finishing	Type **continue in smaller steps**. For big jobs, ask for one page or one part at a time, or use Blueprint.
"Overloaded" (503, 529)	The provider is busy; A.R.I.A. already retried. Wait a minute or switch agent.
"Rate limit" (429)	Too many requests for your plan. Wait, or raise the limit with the provider.
"Key rejected" (401, 403)	The key is wrong, expired or out of credit. Paste a new one and press `Test connection`.
"Model not found" (404)	Press `Load models` and pick a model from the list.
A local model is slow	Choose a smaller size (one that fits the graphics card) in Local models.
It answers but does nothing	Turn on `Computer tools` for the agent; check the permission is not Never.
"Folder not allowed"	Add the folder in `Settings › Permissions › Folders`.

24.2 USB drive

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
Windows blocks the start	`More info` › `Run anyway`.
macOS: "cannot be opened"	Right-click › Open › Open, or `xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine /Volumes/<drive>/macOS`.
Linux: nothing happens	`sudo apt install libfuse2`.
She does not start when plugged in	Install the auto-start helper on this computer (2.8); `ARIA-data` must be in the drive's top folder.
Forgot the password	`Forgot password?`, then paste your API keys again.

24.3 Voice, programs and windows

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
She does not speak	Check `VOICE ON`, the speakers in Devices and the volume.
The wake word or greeting does not react	Download a speech model and press `Use`. Watch the `HEARD` line and add the spelling you see to the names.
She cannot click in a program	Check `Control open programs`, that the program is not blocked, and the requirements in 19.3.

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
The workspace is gone	Click `WORKSPACE//…` on the core's ring, or look for its own window on another monitor.
The terminal says it is not available	Restart A.R.I.A.; on a USB drive, copy the package again (a file may be damaged).
The app is slow or the fan is loud	Lower the network density, turn off animations, or use a smaller local model.

REFERENCE

25 Where things are stored

WHAT	ON A USB DRIVE	ON A COMPUTER
Settings, sessions, skills, plugins, local models	`ARIA-data/app`	`%APPDATA%\ARIA` (Windows), `~/Library/Application Support/ARIA` (macOS), `~/.config/ARIA` (Linux)
API keys	In the settings, encrypted with your password	In the settings, encrypted by the system keychain
Voices and speech models	`ARIA-data/ARIA-voices`	`ARIA-voices` next to the settings folder
Projects	`ARIA Workspace` on the drive	`~/ARIA Workspace` (changeable in Permissions)
A project's blueprint	`blueprint.eve.json` in the project folder	
Deleted files	Your system's trash or recycle bin	

STARTING FRESH

To reset A.R.I.A., close her and delete the settings folder (on a USB drive: `ARIA-data/app`). Projects in the workspace stay where they are. To move to a new computer, use the USB drive — everything comes along.

A.R.I.A. User Manual · version 0.34 · This manual describes A.R.I.A. at the time of writing. Menus and options may change in later versions.